



THE SUMMONING OF CHEPHALI

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What is this?

The Summoning of Chephali is the twenty-sixth monthly small release for **KULT: Divinity Lost**. In this spread you will read the description of a ritual in which a Passion magician summons a nepharite of Gamaliel.



Characters, locations and incidents are portrayed from the metaphorical viewpoint of the *KULT: Divinity Lost* setting.



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THE SUMMONING OF CHEPHALI

A thin haze of smoke hangs in the air. Fat, thick, candles are flickering on the altar. Incense is burnt in Tibetan bronze bowls. Offerings lie placed within chalk circles on the floor: Polaroid photographs of former lovers, a porcelain doll with saffron hair, a glass filled to the brim of red wine, a glass bowl filled with water and petals from orange lotus flowers, drops of virgin menstrual blood on alabaster satin, and a small vial filled with mercury. From hidden speakers comes soft, meditative, music that has a distinct rhythm to it, like that of a slow heartbeat.

The magician is bound on the altar with ceremonial ropes made out of human hair, hemp, jute, and sisal fiber. One rope for each wrist and ankle, and one rope around his neck, squeezing just enough to difficult breathing. Two thick needles pierce each nipple and light cuts have been made on the upper arms to draw some blood.

He was bound like that by his assistant, and for hours the magician has drifted in and out of a state of trance. Psilocybin, viagra, and methamphetamines dancing in his veins. He hasn't slept for two days and haven't had sexual relief in more than a week's time. In this state, in the grip of drugs and ecstasy, reality is starting to blend with dreams. He is the offering in this ritual. His lusts, his desires. A worm on a hook, a bait for the beings beyond the prison. The candle wicks on the altar shortens with each breath drawn.

He mumbles an invocation of summoning to the rhythm of the music.

*From above, to below,
From pleasure, to pain,
From south, to north,
From dream, to flesh.*

Gamaliel, God of Forbidden Desires.

*I call on your many names,
Baphomet, Pan, Frey, Hecate, Persephone, Hel, Dionysus.*

Gamaliel, Shadow of Anima Mundi.

*Guide me,
through the Labyrinth of Dreams,
above the land of Nod,
below the ruins of Edom,
to the Garden of Eden.*

*Let Lilith hand me a cup of blood and sin,
from the Wellspring of all Human Lust.*

Gamaliel, Dark Side of the Moon.

*Send me your Spirits,
Let Succubus and Incubus Illuminate my Path.
Make our Copulation our Covenant,
Grant me the power to manifest my Desires.*

*Gamaliel, God of the Darkest Passions,
I call on you.*

*From above, to below,
From pleasure, to pain,
From south, to north,
From dream, to flesh.*

His words, his desires, pull the spirits of Gamaliel up from the labyrinths of his subconscious. He is radiant there in the darkness. A beacon in a black, dead, spiritual realm. His phosphorus glow illuminates the cracks in the barrier. Shows the spirits where they can slither through and cross the infinite distance between the worlds.

*From above, to below,
From pleasure, to pain,
From south, to north,
From dream, to flesh.*

The magician moves and twists in his ropes, his muscles are strained, his mouth is dry and his body is covered in droplets of sweat. He is painfully erect.

*From above, to below,
From pleasure, to pain,
From south, to north,
From dream, to flesh.*

The magician moves and twists in his ropes, his muscles are strained, his mouth is dry and his body is covered in droplets of sweat. He is painfully erect.

If he loses his focus, if he does not have the stamina, they will slip out of his grip and sink back down. But he feels them. They are now floating right beneath the membrane. Behind his eyelids, they exist on the end of each breath, on the first syllable of each word of the invocation.

*Above.
Below.
Pleasure.
Pain.
South.
North.
Dream.
Flesh.*

Each time he repeats the words it is like he is pulling a rope from some dark and deep well. He sweats profusely. For each pull the rope gets heavier and heavier. His mind wants to give up. Rest, let go. But he feels them. So close.

*Above.
Pleasure.
South.
Dream.*

They drift closer. Their hunger, deep as the dark.

*Below.
Pain.
North.
Flesh.*

Silence fills the room for a few seconds before the membrane between the worlds shiver and the spirits come through.

The magician gasps for air, falls back on the altar and lets his muscles rest. He gives out a sob of relief and just lies there breathing, still bound to the altar. But there is no change around him. The music continues with its meditative rhythm. The last candles flicker. Did the spirits betray him? Or worse, did he only imagine it?

Then he feels a slight change in the atmosphere. A wind that comes from nowhere. A cool breeze against his feverish skin. And he can see them. They glide out of the gloom. Beings of liquid smoke and ashen dreams. He twists his head from side to side, the rope chafes the skin of his throat yet he does not feel it. He studies them. These beings from beyond. Formeless but still, can't he see a face, a hand, eyes? He thinks he can see black flames in the middle of their spirit forms. But they are almost inseparable from the darkness.

They are hungry for physical sensations, circling around his offerings like curious animals. Salivating to take the bait. Smelling, touching and then, after testing the safety of it all, they gather up and glide over each offering as a dark cloud. And from their form there are wet sounds, gusts of wind and low moans of pleasure.

The gifts seem to have been submitted to an invisible flame when they are touched by the spirits: The polaroid photos darken and buckle as they feast on the memories of lust and desire. The doll cracks and its saffron hair coils up and turns to ash as they eat the nightmares of childhood. The glass of red wine and bowl lotus water boils over and with a sharp hiss the fluid evaporates as it hits the floor as they drink aphrodisiacs of passion and bathe in cleansing waters. The fabric with menstrual blood dissolves in thin threads then turns to ash as they defile the innocence. The mercury boils in the vial before it explodes as they eat parts of the creation of the prison.

There is no heat. Only cool and soothing gusts of wind as the spirit eats the essence and the symbolism of those gifts. Fed and strengthened by this they now merge, congeal, and become more and more solid. A shadowy pillar with small grains of white ash that circles the altar hypnotically and studies the magician. And then, through this dark form, she manifests. She steps through.

Her power is radiant.

A feminine being. Tortured, scarred and beautiful. A nepharite of pure lust and hunger.

She studies the magician. Then crawls up on the altar. She licks his chest. Her tongue is unnaturally long and pierced with dozens of scalpel blades. Each lick cuts up his chest and mixes his blood with her saliva. His face is a picture of pure ecstasy. She lets her tongue cut and coil as a serpent as she trails it down his chest, stomach and finally between his legs. Slithering around his erection before taking it into her mouth. He moans, gasps and a thin wisp of smoke leaves his open mouth. His eyes rolled back as some mad seer in a trance.

The unleashed passion starts to unveil the world around him. The walls of the room now seem as thin as the paper of a wasp nest. And beyond them, silhouettes of strange dark towers and endless labyrinths. A ghostly light, neither of dawn nor nightfall.

Over his moans and the wet sounds we can hear a choir of suffering and the rolling, sluggish, waves from some distant sea.

Now phantom mirages appear in the air above the man.

Projections of his forbidden desires, his most secret lusts. They flicker in the smoke and change and twist and as one is gone a new one appears.

A Woman's body draped in seaweed as she moans and arches on black chapel stones. A hand with slender fingers gripping sleep twisted sheets. A black, oily, machinery that leaks drops of white fluid from delicate pores when it is touched. A child floating in a dark void, snails slowly crawl over it leaving tracks of glittering silver. A book in some dim chamber that when opened reveals wet folds of flesh.

Somewhere in the ecstasy the magician remembers that he needs to keep control. That if he lets everything go, he will be emptied. And he will risk becoming her slave. And at this moment, nothing feels more tempting than that. But the magician

keeps his focus. He studies the images, his desires, and in them he understands hidden meanings, untold mysteries, secrets behind rituals and mantras tied to Gamaliel's powers of lust and depravity.

The woman works on him harder and faster. The bladed tongue is constricting around him, cutting him up, blood is gushing out of her mouth. More and more images, lusts and fantasies are breathed out on the wisps of smoke. Ectoplasm of purest, unhindered, passion. He is laying a puzzle. Reshaping his understanding of the world. His insight in his spirit, his flesh, his desires. And here he also sees her name, **Chephali**.

He meets the eye of the demon. Her mouth closed around him, feral, furious of not having control over him. Instead the magician commands her: *"I have seen enough, Chephali. Finish the ritual."*

With an animalistic hiss her tongue pushes itself into his narrow urethra, penetrates the magician, the body, the soul. Digs itself deep into his stomach as he reaches the climax. His bound body arches. He screams, screams, and screams in convulsive orgasm. And with the sound of a great wind the paper thin walls rip apart. In that moment he reaches true, divine, insight. Just for a few seconds.

He collapses back into reality, into his body, into his flesh. He is bound to the altar. The demon is gone, but he can still feel her presence. It will be easier to summon her next time. And his mind is overfilled with new insights.

